

- Do you think this current system provides adequate accountability around short-term rentals in San Francisco? In your response, describe why you believe the system is adequate or inadequate. If you believe the system is inadequate, discuss a possible change in actions required to improve accountability in this system. You may refer to the SWE Code of Ethics as you think through your response.

I think the current system does effectively hold everyone accountable in the short term. I think this for a few reasons. Firstly, the reviews feature makes hosts compelled to keep their properties in quality condition. The practice of web-scraping as a whole holds Airbnb accountable I think, because if people can get access to their data, there is less they can hide. In this assignment we saw they deny public access to the data on their web, but I still believe if you have a public website you are held to a certain degree of standard where you have to maintain transparency about things like prices, quality of property, location, etc.

- As discussed in the introduction, the legality of web scraping is still uncertain in the US. Skim through the Legal Issues section of Web Scraping in the US on Wikipedia and this article about the legal issues with the Computer Fraud and Abuse Act, and describe at least one factor you believe is important to consider when discussing the legality of web scraping and why.

I think the number one factor to consider when looking at this issue is if the data is publicly available. If it is, I see no reason why web scraping should be illegal. I could understand if an online business wanted to keep their order and revenue numbers private, but for a website like Airbnb, data such as the average price per night, the rating of different hosts, and validity of policy numbers all play into the accountability talked about above. I think big public businesses should have some degree of accountability and transparency with their data, and if they don't want it out in the public they shouldn't have it on their website.

- Scraping public data does not always lead to positive results for society. For example, look to Facebook–Cambridge Analytica data scandal - Wikipedia or Clearview AI - Wikipedia. Many argue that using someone's personal data without their consent (even if publicly provided) is unethical. Web scraping requires thoughtful intervention. Develop at least two guidelines you think are important to consider when deciding whether to do web scraping.

I think the first consideration should be if it is helpful or harmful to a common human. If you decide to scrape data from a bunch of users on a social media website to see who might be the most vulnerable to buy your product, that is exploitative and should not be a common use of web scraping. However, if you web scrape to track down misinformation spreads on social media, that is a beneficial use. Another guideline could be that you should only look to obtain data you need, and not every little piece. If you have a common ethical goal in mind, I see no problem with scraping only that information. But if you scrape up other, potentially more personal data either on purpose or mistakenly, that could lead to unintended consequences for you or others whose data you now have.